

U1L05 Quick Reference — HTML Lists

Syntax

Goal	Code
Bullet list	<code>Item</code>
Numbered list	<code>Step</code>
One item	<code>Text</code>
Nested list	Inner <code></code> goes before <code></code>
Link inside a list	<code>Text</code>
Emmet, 3 items	<code>ul>li*3</code> + Tab
Emmet, nested	<code>ul>li*2>ul>li*3</code> + Tab

Which Container?

Ask: if I shuffled these, would it still make sense?

Answer	Use	Examples
Still fine	<code></code>	Ingredients, hobbies, menu links
It breaks	<code></code>	Recipe steps, directions, rankings

```
<ul>
  <li>Pizza</li>
  <li>Tacos</li>
</ul>

<ol>
  <li>Wake up</li>
  <li>Eat</li>
</ol>
```

💡 Only the container tag changes. The `<li>` items are identical.

Two Tags, Always

- **Container** — `<ul>` or `<ol>` . Declares a list starts here.
- **Item** — `<li>` . One entry.

⚠ Only `<li>` goes **directly** inside a container.

	
<code><p>Pizza</p></code>	<code>Pizza</code>

💡 Anything can go *inside* an `<li>` — text, links, bold, another list. Just not beside it.

Nesting — the rule that matters

The inner list goes **INSIDE** the `<li>` .

```
<ul>
  <li>Breakfast
    <ul>
      <li>Cereal</li>
      <li>Toast</li>
    </ul>
  </li>
</ul>
```

Watch the `</li>` . It closes **after** the inner `</ul>` .

⚠ This is the most common mistake:

```
<li>Breakfast</li>
<ul>
  <li>Cereal</li>
</ul>
```

The `</li>` closed too early, so the sub-list is a sibling instead of a child. It can still *look* right — the structure is wrong, and it breaks when you style it in Unit 2.

💡 Browsers will guess where a missing `</li>` belongs. They guess wrong the moment you nest. Close every tag.

Lists + Links = Navigation

```
<ul>
  <li><a href="index.html">Home</a></li>
  <li><a href="about.html">About</a></li>
  <li><a href="#contact">Contact</a></li>
</ul>
```

💡 The `<a>` goes **inside** the `<li>`. Every navigation menu on the web is built this way.

Emmet

Symbol	Means	Example
>	inside	ul>li
*	repeat	li*5

```
ul>li*3      → a ul with 3 items
ol>li*4      → an ol with 4 items
ul>li*2>ul>li*3 → 2 items, each with a sub-list of 3
```

Type the shorthand, press **Tab**.

⚠️ Emmet is a speed tool, not a substitute for knowing the structure. There's no Tab key on the test.

Fixes

Problem	Cause	Fix
Sub-list not indented under its item	<code></code> closed too early	Move <code></code> after the inner <code></code>
Numbers where you wanted bullets	Used <code></code>	Change container to <code></code>
Item text not lining up	<code><p></code> or bare text inside the list	Wrap it in <code></code>
Whole list is one link	<code><a></code> wraps the <code></code>	Put <code><a></code> inside each <code></code>
List renders scrambled after nesting	Missing <code></code>	Close every item

Complete Working Page

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>My Recipe</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1 id="top">Banana Bread</h1>

  <ul>
    <li><a href="#steps">Jump to steps</a></li>
  </ul>

  <h2>Ingredients</h2>
  <ul>
    <li>3 ripe bananas</li>
    <li>3/4 cup sugar</li>
  </ul>

  <h2 id="steps">Steps</h2>
  <ol>
    <li>Mash the bananas.</li>
    <li>Mix in the sugar.</li>
  </ol>

  <h2>Notes</h2>
  <ul>
    <li>Equipment
      <ul>
        <li>Loaf pan</li>
      </ul>
    </li>
  </ul>
</body>
</html>
```